



Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION

For : **The Officer-in-Charge, UNDERSECRETARY**
For Railways

From : **SENIOR TRANSPORTATION DEVELOPMENT OFFICER**
Project Development and Implementation Division

Subject : **REQUEST FOR SIGNATURE ON THE AUSTRALIA AWARDS
SCHOLARSHIP APPLICATION DOCUMENTARY
REQUIREMENTS**

Date : **25 April 2024**

1.0 Introduction

- 1.1 This refers to Australia Awards Scholarship Application Program Summary¹ issued by the DOTr Personnel Development Committee ("PDC"). Attached herewith is the revised Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP)² titled "Inclusive Design Enforcement Plan for the Railways Sector".
- 1.2 The REAP had undergone minimal revisions as instructed by PDC and by the panel during the application deliberation last 19 April 2024.

2.0 Requested Action

- 2.1 The undersigned requests your signature of the abovementioned. The attached documents are intended as part of the documentary requirements of PDC in the application of the said scholarship.

Sincerely,

SALIMA B. AWIS

Digitally signed by
Awis Salima Bitana
Date: 2024.04.29
09:59:19 +08'00'

Attachment:

Attachment 1: Australia Awards Scholarship Application Program Summary
Attachment 2: Revised REAP
Attachment 3: Previously signed REAP, PPTAF, and Nomination Form

¹ Australia Awards Scholarship Application Program Summary

² Revised Re-Entry Action Plan



Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION

PROGRAM SUMMARY

Program Title: **Australia Awards Scholarship**

Training Period/Venue: **In-campus study shall commence in 2025**

Development Partner: **Australia Awards and Alumni Engagement Program - Philippines (AAEP-P)**

Program Objective:

The program aims to contribute to the development needs of the Philippines in line with its bilateral agreements with Australia. It provides opportunities for Filipinos to undertake full-time postgraduate study at any of Australia's world-class universities. This will equip Filipino leaders with the knowledge and skills to contribute to change and development in the Philippines.

As a valued partner agency of Australia Awards Philippines, we strongly welcome nominations from the Department of Transportation for master's degree studies. Based on your agency's organizational training needs assessment, this year's priority focus areas are:

- Digital transformation (including data analytics);
- Project development and management;
- Human resource management and development (Program to Institutionalize Meritocracy and Excellence in Human Resource Management);
- Strategic communication;
- Strategic and agile leadership;
- Knowledge management;
- Climate change adaptation; and
- Gender equality, disability, and social inclusion

Qualifications and Eligibility and Documentary Requirements:

DOTr - PDC :

- Holder of a bachelor's degree
- Permanent appointment; preferably SG-18 and above

- Has not received any study program (foreign/local) for the past two (2) years.
- Very Satisfactory (VS) rating for two (2) consecutive periods
- Be in a leadership role where the enhanced technical or managerial skills to be gained via the recommended AAAEP-P study program can be used to effectively contribute to the agreed change agenda of the organization
- Preferably at least five (5) year work experience with public sector
- Not have pending permanent residency application in Australia, New Zealand and other countries, not be married, or engaged to, or a de facto of, an Australian/New Zealand citizen
- Not have pending obligations from Australia Awards or another scholarship program
- Not currently holding another scholarship and that would result in overlapping contracts as well as benefits
- No pending application to other scholarship programs locally or internationally
- No pending administrative, criminal or civil case

AAAEP-P:

- have passed the interview process of the agency's scholarship committee
- have passed the medical screening of partner organization
- be able to take up the scholarship place in the academic year for which the award is offered
- should be willing to sign a scholarship contract with Australia Awards
- should be willing to sign a service contract with the nominating agency
- should be willing to sign an agreement to fully implement the REAP
- have achieved a satisfactory English Proficiency Result: 6.5 overall band in IELTS with no individual band scores lower than 6.0; or above 92 TOEFL IBT results; or 58 overall band in PTE with no individual band scores lower than 54.

*This is required once nominee has been selected as a Provisional Priority Candidate.

Checklist of Documentary Requirements:

1.0 DOTr- PDC (Central Office Applicants)	
	Duly accomplished and signed Scholarship Nomination Form (<i>please see prescribed form</i>);
	Updated Personal Data Sheet (PDS) with Work Experience Sheet (WES);
	IPCR for the last two (2) rating periods (<i>if any</i>);
	Duly accomplished and signed Potential and Personality Trait Assessment Form (PPTAF; <i>please see prescribed form</i>);
	Updated Service Record (<i>for applicants from Attached Agencies and Sectoral Offices</i>);
	Certificate of No Pending Administrative Case;

2.0 AAAEP-P	
	Curriculum Vitae (CV) and application form, to be filled out through an online form. Please use this link: https://form.jotform.me/70298628003456?propoaccessCode=January%202025%20Intake%20-%20Targeted to access the form.
	Graduation Certificate (with GWA/GPA indicated): Secured from the academic institution where they completed their highest completed degree, the certificate must indicate the details of the course including your General Weighted Average (GWA) or Grade Point Average (GPA) - upload online.
	Certificate of Citizenship and Residency (Birth Certificate will be accepted for Targeted nominees) - upload online.
	Signed Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP) that outlines a project where their newly acquired knowledge and skills from Australia will be used to contribute to development in the Philippines (template here: https://www.australiaawardsphilippines.org/scholarships/applicants/resources/downloadable-forms/reap-form-2021-annotated-20210202.doc/download)

Application Procedure:

All interested officials/personnel from the DOTr-Central Office must comply with the AAAEP-P and PDC documentary requirements enumerated above and forward them to the DOTr-Personnel Development Committee (PDC) through the Human Resource Development Division.

All nominations shall pass through the DOTr-PDC. Applicants failing to submit the complete requirements within the deadline may not be considered for the program.

Likewise, please notify the DOTr-PDC through a formal notice, or send to this email, if your office is declining the program offer.

Deadline of nomination: [09 April 2024](#)

For inquiries/clarification please email Ms. Grace B. at grace.bautista@dotr.gov.ph / Ms. Esmeralda R. at esmeralda.rodriguez@dotr.gov.ph or call us at 8790 8300 local 4402.



Australia Awards

REAP Form (for Applicants of 2025 Intake)

The Re-entry Action Plan (REAP) is a formal document that represents a scholar's commitment to honor the conditions of the Australia Awards Scholarships (see Scholarship Handbook section 4.2). It is a mechanism that allows scholars to apply what they have learned in Australia to contribute to Philippine development through a meaningful project in an organisation or community.

- I. RELEVANCE OF THE REAP.** The REAP should clearly and succinctly explain how the delivery of its proposed output or outputs will improve the services or performance of the Host Organisation and ultimately contribute to the achievement of the goals set in the Philippine Government's Ambisyon Natin 2040, and the goals of the Australian Government in the Philippines.

Fill out the following sections after reading these required documents.

Name of Proponent	Salima B. Awis
REAP Title	<i>Inclusive Design Enforcement Plan for the Railways Sector</i>
REAP Objective	<i>This aims to provide a systematic and effective enforcement plan of inclusive design for the Railways Sector's different projects through the realization of the two recently published technical standards for inclusivity, Batas Pambansa 344 – Accessibility Law Revised Implementing Rules and Regulation, and Transit Facility Design Standards: Inclusive Facilities</i>
Name of Host Organisation	<i>This REAP will be implemented to the Railways Sector of the Department of Transportation, Philippines</i>
Description of the Host Organisation and relation to REAP	<i>How did you come to know about this organisation and why did you choose it to be your host?</i> <i>I am employed under the Department of Transportation – Railways Sector as Senior Transportation Development Officer. I oversee the Gender Equality, Disability and Social Inclusion (GEDSI) Infrastructure workstream of the North-South Commuter Railway Extension (NSCR-Ex) Project Management Office. The NSCR-Ex Project, a flagship project of the Department and of the Railways Sector, was one of the few projects that were able to implement in</i>

	<i>advance different inclusive design best practices and policies as we were required by our loaning agency, Asian Development Bank.</i> <i>I chose our sector to be the host of my REAP as I've seen, as I assist the rest of the railway sector projects/ lines through my sectoral role, how the situation is different with the existing operating railway lines, soon-to-operate lines, ongoing construction railway lines and future railway lines as these projects have different project terms of references with different project requirements. There is definitely a need to streamline the process of implementing an inclusive railways service within the Railways Sector.</i> <i>Different railway projects experience difficulties in the implementation, especially in the past years when technical standards are non-existent, due to lack of budget, consultant and contractor apprehension, lack of staff capacity and technical know-how, lack of legal policies and requirements compelling the project to apply inclusive design, and not embedding inclusive design since the project inception.</i> How can your relationship / connectedness with the Host Organisation help you in completely implementing your REAP? <i>I was part of the TWGs of both technical standards, BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, who co-authored these documents, and my main workstream is GEDSI Infrastructure of the Railways Sector, therefore I am directly working and assisting in the implementation of Inclusive Infrastructure Design policies in all railway projects through my division, Project Development and Implementation Division, under Rail-Unified Project Management Office, side by side with my role of overseeing inclusive infrastructure in the NSCR-Ex Projects under the Infrastructure Design Section. Being in this position, I already have an overview of the current situation of the Railways Sector and how is the current situation of the implementation of inclusive design policies, as well as the gaps and difficulties that the Railways Sector face.</i>
BACKGROUND INFORMATION	
Problem / Opportunity	The Accessibility Law (BP344) has recently been revised by our Department, DOTr, where the aim is to incorporate the latest international best practices in universal mobility for the benefit of the persons with disabilities. The TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, is a standard, published by DOTr through a department order, is a document that aims to standardize DOTr's initiative on GEDSI mainstreaming in transit facilities to become more convenient, accessible, safe, secure, and inclusive for all users, regardless of status (disability, gender identity, age, etc). TFDS also aims to address the intersectionality gaps from BP344. Making these two standards fully effective in all the projects of DOTr through a robust implementation plan will help deliver inclusive outcomes for the Department. The two standards are not retroactive, therefore only future projects will be required to implement these new standards. It is anticipated, however, that existing operating Railway Lines will undergo renovations in the next years, which subjects them to implement TFDS and BP344. It is also vital that the principles of these inclusive

	laws be adapted in all of the transport facilities of the Railways sector, regardless of its operational/ construction status. As my previous experience in overseeing, working and assisting different railway projects in mainstreaming GEDSI in each of their project, I have witnessed how the different rail project management offices are lacking guidance in inclusive design approach due non-existent dedicated team accountable for inclusivity mainstreaming, and due to the unfamiliarity of inclusivity principles. From the news articles that surfaced last 2023 regarding the inaccessibility of the three existing operating railway lines, LRT-1, LRT-2 and MRT-3 have been subject to criticisms and accessibility audits by private groups and persons with disabilities sector. Most issues that were raised were addressed through operations, and through improving passenger information. However, all the three operating lines have difficulty in addressing the pointed accessibility issues if it requires infrastructure mitigations because of the lack of budget. A robust implementation plan for BP344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities shall be developed to target the realization of: SDG8 Decent work and economic growth, SDG4 Quality education, as it will enhance work prospects for the vulnerable sectors as they experience more confidence in using railway transportation therefore increasing their mobility, travel patterns, work opportunities and access to better education, SDG10 Reduced inequalities, SDG5 Gender equality through the promoting an overall inclusive railways service that welcomes every user and provides positive experience, and SDG11 Sustainable Cities by improving accessible and inclusive physical and information access for railways. While the concerned agencies (DOTr, DPWH and NCDA) that were involved in the drafting of the technical standards, are ongoing in the information dissemination and capacity building for all the stakeholders, actual implementation and enforcement of the standards to the projects must come after. Effectivity of the enforcement of both BP344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities will rely on the robustness of its Implementation Plan which shall cover its effective and systematic enforcement, as well as its monitoring and evaluation.
BENEFICIARIES	
Direct Beneficiary	<i>Who will directly benefit from the implementation of your REAP? How many target beneficiaries does your REAP have? How will your REAP help your target beneficiaries? (200 words)</i> The Railways Sector will directly benefit on the implementation of this REAP as this aims to provide guidance to the implementors of the different railway projects of the department. In doing so, this will then benefit all the passengers using the railways service of the department, specifically the persons with disabilities, pregnant, senior citizens, children and the rest of the groups that are part of the vulnerable population. It shall also be acknowledged that providing an inclusive railways service will also benefit the department, the railways sector and its

	Operators as it has been proven that an inclusive railways service produces higher profit income to the service providers as it welcomes more passenger to use the facilities including persons with disabilities, women, children, senior citizens and LGBTQIA+ individuals who also have disposable incomes which will contribute to the profit of the Railways Operators/ Sectors.
Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI)	<i>How will women and other marginalised groups (i.e., IP, PWD, LGBTQ++, etc) benefit from the implementation of your REAP? Provide specific strategies to respond to the needs of the specific groups.</i> (200 words) This REAP is directly addressing the implementation and enforcement of the GEDSI policies in the department, hence directly targets how to have outcomes of an inclusive railways service. In providing guidance to the implementation of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, the Railways Sector will have a step by step and applicable way to effectively implement these policies which will benefit the passengers through: 1. For persons with disabilities, Senior citizens, IP – full enforcement of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS Inclusive Facilities on different projects of the Railways sector will help improve on the accessibility of the stations, trains and the railways service. It should be acknowledged that one of the largest barriers that hinders the persons with disability in fully integrating to the society is the physical environment's inaccessibility and not the disability. Providing a fully accessible and inclusive facilities will encourage persons with disabilities to use the railways service which will improve their mobility, hence expanding the different opportunities and options they may be provided with, improving their quality of life. 2. For Women, Children, Pregnant – in the implementation of an inclusive railways service through the BP 344 and Inclusive Facilities enforcement, this will help improve in the transportation patterns for women, children, pregnant making it convenient for them to choose the public transportation by providing inclusive facilities. It is known that women/ mothers have different transportation patterns because of their acquired domestic roles in a household on top of their daily work. In providing an inclusive railways service, women will have more confidence when accessing the railway facilities as it caters to their specific needs, hence improving their transportation patterns. In the long run, the REAP also aims to improve the options for women of different transportation modes by using an inclusive railways service so they won't have to be limited in the location of the work available for them, at the same time fulfilling their chosen (or acquired) parenting/ caregiving duties. 3. For LGBTQIA+ individuals – full enforcement of accessible and inclusive facilities in the Railways sector will provide a safe and inclusive space for passengers with diverse SOGIESC that will choose to use the railway network. LGBTQIA+ individuals will have confidence that they will not be discriminated in the railway facilities by knowing that inclusive facilities and safeguards are readily provided for all, providing a feeling of being welcome and safe, and positive experiences in the public transportation.

Climate Change Adaptation, Disaster Risk Reduction and Environmental Protection	<i>How your REAP will contribute to climate change adaptation, disaster risk reduction and environmental protection? The contribution could be in the manner of REAP implementation (e.g., use of products/materials that are environment-friendly or reducing the carbon footprints) or the use of REAP output/s to mitigate climate and disaster risks and protect the environment. (200 words)</i> Improving the Railways by the implementation of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive facilities will give confidence to commuters and passengers in using railway facilities. Therefore, lessening each commuters and passengers carbon footprint as they subscribe with mass transportation vs owning and using personal vehicle which only benefit a few people per vehicle per trip.
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II. IMPACT AND SUSTAINABILITY OF THE ORGANISATIONAL OUTCOME OF THE REAP. The REAP should produce an output/s that will help the Host Organisation improve their services or performance. These improvements are the outcome/s of your REAP. You should therefore clearly articulate your strategies for the Host Organisation will sustain the gains of the REAP after its completion. (TIP: Based on our survey, the following factors ensure the effective implementation of REAP: the goals of the REAP should align with the goals of the Host Organisation and the Host Organisation is committed to the completion and full implementation of your REAP.)

Development impact and Sustainability	<i>How will your REAP contribute to the achievement of the goals of the Host Organisation?</i> <i>What is your strategy to ensure that the gains of the REAP will be institutionalised and sustained beyond the REAP completion?</i> <i>(400 words)</i> To fulfill the Department's dedication in providing Comfortable, Accessible, Safe, Sustainable, and Affordable transportation for Filipinos, it is necessary that inclusive railway service be established and embedded consistently throughout the railway network. As this REAP focuses on the Comfortability and Accessibility, hence an inclusive railways service, it is aligned with the goals of the Department. The outcomes may be used in the further mainstreaming of GEDSI in other sectors of the Department. A dedicated committee/TWG shall be created department wide which shall monitor all the relative inclusivity implementation of the transportation facilities. The process of providing an overall inclusive service will be centralized, with top to bottom/bottom up approach, standardizing the enforcement and implementation of inclusivity in the department's railway, maritime, road and aviation sectors. The REAP can be escalated as a Department Order creating a committee/TWG/permanent office which specializes and focuses on anything related to the implementation of an inclusive transportation service through infrastructure, operations and information enforcement. Support shall be sought from the Planning arm of the Department for M&E as this is also the sector that initiates the creation of the two new inclusive infrastructure standards - BP344
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	Accessibility Law Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities.
Organisational Outcome	<i>Identify at least one outcome of your REAP. How will your REAP improve service delivery, policies, systems, or competencies in the Host Organisation?</i> <i>Please identify which organizational outcome your REAP will address:</i> ○ <i>Improvement of Services Delivery</i> ○ <i>Improvement on Organisational Structure</i> ○ <i>Systems Improvement</i> ○ <i>Policy Review and Formulation</i> ○ <i>Building Competencies</i> ○ <i>Others</i> <i>(200 words)</i> The organization will improve the services delivery, organizational structure, systems, and policy review and formulation through the creation of a dedicated committee or TWG which will focus on the accessibility and inclusivity improvement of all the Railways Project moving forward. As per the different international practices, at a Department/ Ministry for Transport, I noticed that there is always a dedicated committee/ TWG that are involved of ensuring that all the facilities and operational procedures of the transportation facilities are accessible and inclusive. If the inclusive design enforcement plan will be realized, one of its key outcomes is to have a dedicated committee/ TWG, therefore improving the process of the Railways Sector/ department in having an inclusive railways service.
Output	<i>What output/s will your REAP produce? How will these outputs contribute to achieving the targeted organisational outcome? (200 words)</i> This REAP aims to have an output that will provide a systematic, time bound and effective enforcement plan of inclusive design for the Railways Sector's different projects, in different project timelines, through the realization of BP 344 Revised IRR and Inclusive Facilities. As mentioned above, the creation of a dedicated committee/ TWG which will focus solely on the enforcement, monitoring and evaluation of an inclusive railways service will start and create a streamlined process for the Railways Sector. Through the committee/ TWG, it will help push and prioritize providing inclusive infrastructure and railways service such as provisions for all-inclusive toilets, breastfeeding rooms, accessible and inclusive passenger route, accessible conveyances – all this will be provided for both passengers and station personnel.
Competencies	<i>What competencies do you hope to improve or gain when you study in Australia? How will your proposed program of study help provide these competencies? You must clearly and succinctly articulate the importance of your proposed program of study to providing the competencies you need to implement your REAP. (200 words)</i>

	I have recently known, through a recent workshop with the Partners for Infrastructure of the Australian Embassy, that the Queensland government have an accessibility committee/ office that are dedicated in the enforcement, monitoring and evaluation, and even improvements of existing policies regarding an inclusive and accessible overall transportation for Queensland. I'd like to know more in depth, how the Australian Government from the federal to the state level, until at the concentrated government, how they were able to push for accessible and inclusive transport with the top to bottom approach, and how necessary and influential it is in their context. With the difference of governance with Australia, I acknowledge that some of the difficulties of the Philippine government may not be seen and applicable, but any strategies and approach will still be helpful as long as it aligns with the goal of an inclusive railways service. Knowing this, I'd like to focus on policy making/ developmental management courses that are also in connection to an inclusive built-environment programs available in Australian universities.
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III. IMPLEMENTABILITY OF THE REAP. The REAP should be fully implemented within two years from when a scholar returns from Australia. The applicant should clearly and succinctly explain how he/she will implement the REAP within the required timeframe and budget. (TIP: The scale of your REAP should be within your circle of influence and control to ensure doability.)

Measurability

How will you track the progress of the implementation of your REAP? What are your milestones? Divide your REAP activities and timeline into four (4) milestones: 25%, 50%, 75% and 100%.

Action Steps (What activities will contribute to the milestones)	Expected Output	Timeline
25%		
Production of an enforcement plan (with monitoring, and evaluation) of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities for different stages of the different Railways sector projects.	Final Implementation Plan of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities	6 months
50%		
Creation of a committee that will focus on the implementation of an Inclusive Railway Facilities. Their mandate will solely focus on the enforcement plan with monitoring and evaluation of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities.	Accessible and Inclusive Transport Committee involving key representatives that are directly involved in the different railway projects implementation	6 months

75%		
Seek the approval of the principals on the final implementation plan of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities with the Inclusive Design Committee	Signed and approved final Enforcement Plan of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, and the Accessible and Inclusive Transport Committee	6 months
100%		
Issuance and application of the Inclusive Design Enforcement Plan for the Railways Sector to the different Railways project with different project timelines and statuses. Mobilization of the Accessible and Inclusive Transport Committee	Memo of instruction for the application of the Inclusive Design Enforcement Plan Start of enforcement of inclusive design to the different railways projects.	1 months (issuance)

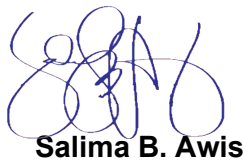
Resources	<i>Estimate the budget (in terms of pesos per budget item) you require to successfully implement your REAP.</i> <i>Include your strategy for accessing the necessary financial support.</i> <i>Note that Australia Awards will not fund your REAP implementation. (200 words)</i> Php 500,000 and above. As this REAP will require an existing office, which is the Railways Sector, to implement a proposed enforcement plan, this REAP shall use the resources and the workforce of the railways office. Hence, it is unmeasurable as of now as it will maximize the workforce present through a creating a committee or a Technical Working Group. However, expenses on the actual enforcement of accessible and inclusive facilities to different railways projects shall also incur cost. The budget for the actual enforcement shall come from each project's annual approved budget/ loaning agreement with development partners or Public-Private Partnership. Another option would be, is for the Railways Sector to hire a committee or a group solely dedicated in the implementation of the enforcement plan as well as its monitoring and evaluation of the different railways project up until its Operations and Maintenance. Therefore, this will entail an additional workforce to the organizational structure of the Railways sector which will add to the expenses of the department providing compensation to the committee.
REAP Start Date and End Date	July 2026 – May 2028

RISKS AND MITIGATING MEASURE

Describe the risks that might impact on the success of the Action Plan and how you plan to manage these to ensure success. (Identify factors that will block/limit/slowdown accomplishment of intended results or lessen quality of outputs.)

<i>RISK</i>	<i>MITIGATING MEASURE</i>
<i>Change of administration and instruction</i>	A sustainable and approved plan must be established before the change of administration happens. In this way, continuation of the implementation plan will be assured regardless of the administration.
<i>Budget allocation</i>	Budget allocation for the Department which will be used for the implementation to the projects may take a long time before being granted. Airtight justification on the urgency and need for such enforcement plan shall be provided so the budget allocation to provide an inclusive railway service will be secured.

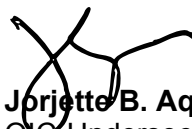
Signed by:



Salima B. Awis

Digitally signed by
Awis Salima Bitana
Date: 2024.04.29
10:01:44 +08'00'

Signed by:



Jorjette B. Aquino
OIC-Undersecretary for Railways
S.O. No. 2024-136

Digitally signed by:
JORJETTE B AQUINO
25-Apr-24
10:37:10 GMT+8



DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION

(ALWAYS ATTACH THIS FORM TO
ALL COMMUNICATIONS)

JSR 24-3685

[illegible]



Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION

For : **The UNDERSECRETARY**
For Railways

From : **SENIOR TRANSPORTATION DEVELOPMENT OFFICER**
Project Development and Implementation Division

Subject : **REQUEST FOR SIGNATURE ON THE AUSTRALIA AWARDS
SCHOLARSHIP APPLICATION DOCUMENTARY
REQUIREMENTS**

Date : **17 April 2024**

1.0 Introduction

- 1.1 This refers to Australia Awards Scholarship Application Program Summary¹ issued by the DOTr Personnel Development Committee ("PDC"). Attached herewith is the complete documentary requirements as listed in the program summary for submission to PDC.

2.0 Requested Action

- 2.1 The undersigned requests your approval of the abovementioned. The attached documents are intended as part of the documentary requirements of PDC prior to the application of the said scholarship.

Sincerely,

SALIMA B. AWIS

Digitally signed by
Awis Salima Bitana
Date: 2024.04.17
21:26:04 +08'00'

Attachment:

Attachment 1: Australia Awards Scholarship Application Program Summary
Attachment 2: DOTr PDC Requirements
Attachment 3: AAAEP-P Requirements

¹ Australia Awards Scholarship Application Program Summary



Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION

PROGRAM SUMMARY

Program Title: **Australia Awards Scholarship**

Training Period/Venue: **In-campus study shall commence in 2025**

Development Partner: **Australia Awards and Alumni Engagement Program - Philippines (AAEP-P)**

Program Objective:

The program aims to contribute to the development needs of the Philippines in line with its bilateral agreements with Australia. It provides opportunities for Filipinos to undertake full-time postgraduate study at any of Australia's world-class universities. This will equip Filipino leaders with the knowledge and skills to contribute to change and development in the Philippines.

As a valued partner agency of Australia Awards Philippines, we strongly welcome nominations from the Department of Transportation for master's degree studies. Based on your agency's organizational training needs assessment, this year's priority focus areas are:

- Digital transformation (including data analytics);
- Project development and management;
- Human resource management and development (Program to Institutionalize Meritocracy and Excellence in Human Resource Management);
- Strategic communication;
- Strategic and agile leadership;
- Knowledge management;
- Climate change adaptation; and
- Gender equality, disability, and social inclusion

Qualifications and Eligibility and Documentary Requirements:

DOTr - PDC :

- Holder of a bachelor's degree
- Permanent appointment; preferably SG-18 and above

- Has not received any study program (foreign/local) for the past two (2) years.
- Very Satisfactory (VS) rating for two (2) consecutive periods
- Be in a leadership role where the enhanced technical or managerial skills to be gained via the recommended AAAEP-P study program can be used to effectively contribute to the agreed change agenda of the organization
- Preferably at least five (5) year work experience with public sector
- Not have pending permanent residency application in Australia, New Zealand and other countries, not be married, or engaged to, or a de facto of, an Australian/New Zealand citizen
- Not have pending obligations from Australia Awards or another scholarship program
- Not currently holding another scholarship and that would result in overlapping contracts as well as benefits
- No pending application to other scholarship programs locally or internationally
- No pending administrative, criminal or civil case

AAAEP-P:

- have passed the interview process of the agency's scholarship committee
- have passed the medical screening of partner organization
- be able to take up the scholarship place in the academic year for which the award is offered
- should be willing to sign a scholarship contract with Australia Awards
- should be willing to sign a service contract with the nominating agency
- should be willing to sign an agreement to fully implement the REAP
- have achieved a satisfactory English Proficiency Result: 6.5 overall band in IELTS with no individual band scores lower than 6.0; or above 92 TOEFL IBT results; or 58 overall band in PTE with no individual band scores lower than 54.

*This is required once nominee has been selected as a Provisional Priority Candidate.

Checklist of Documentary Requirements:

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	Certificate of No Pending Administrative Case;

2.0 AAAEP-P	
	Curriculum Vitae (CV) and application form, to be filled out through an online form. Please use this link: https://form.jotform.me/70298628003456?propoaccessCode=January%202025%20Intake%20-%20Targeted to access the form.
	Graduation Certificate (with GWA/GPA indicated): Secured from the academic institution where they completed their highest completed degree, the certificate must indicate the details of the course including your General Weighted Average (GWA) or Grade Point Average (GPA) - upload online.
	Certificate of Citizenship and Residency (Birth Certificate will be accepted for Targeted nominees) - upload online.
	Signed Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP) that outlines a project where their newly acquired knowledge and skills from Australia will be used to contribute to development in the Philippines (template here: https://www.australiaawardsphilippines.org/scholarships/applicants/resources/downloadable-forms/reap-form-2021-annotated-20210202.doc/download)

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All interested officials/personnel from the DOTr-Central Office must comply with the AAAEP-P and PDC documentary requirements enumerated above and forward them to the DOTr-Personnel Development Committee (PDC) through the Human Resource Development Division.

All nominations shall pass through the DOTr-PDC. Applicants failing to submit the complete requirements within the deadline may not be considered for the program.

Likewise, please notify the DOTr-PDC through a formal notice, or send to this email, if your office is declining the program offer.

Deadline of nomination: 09 April 2024

For inquiries/clarification please email Ms. Grace B. at grace.bautista@dotr.gov.ph / Ms. Esmeralda R. at esmeralda.rodriguez@dotr.gov.ph or call us at 8790 8300 local 4402.



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Transportation

Document No: DOTr-HRDD-Forms-002 Rev. No.: 002 Effective Date: 13 April 2023

SCHOLARSHIP NOMINATION FORM (STUDY AND NON-STUDY)

INSTRUCTIONS: This document is used to nominate an employee for a Study and/or a Non-study Scholarship Program. Please fill out this form, and then scan and attach the signed duplicate to the Online Nomination Form. Take note that answers to each question must be elaborated properly as this shall be the reference of the Personnel Development Committee in their rating.

TITLE OF THE SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM:	Australia Awards
I. APPLICANT'S INFORMATION	
Name: Salima B. Awis	Position Title: Senior Transportation Development Officer
No. of years in the Government Service (if transferred): n/a	No. of years in the DOTr/AAs/SOs: 1 year as Plantilla Personnel (Jan 2023 – Present) 2 years and 2 months as JO/COS (Nov 2020 – Jan 2023)
Office/Unit: Office of the Undersecretary for Railways	Immediate Supervisor:
II. RELEVANCE OF THE PROGRAM	
A. Office/Division's Mandate	
The Project Development and Implementation Division (PDID) handles all aspects of the railway projects of the DOTr, from project planning, formulation, implementation, and management. Including addressing of issues/concerns and bottlenecks during project development and implementation.	
B. Personnel's Function	
As the acting Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI) focal of the Railways Sector under PDID, with the position of Senior Transportation Development Officer, I oversee, mainstream and assist in the implementation of GEDSI infrastructure in the Railway sector projects such as the operating railway lines (LRT-1, LRT-2 and MRT-3), soon-to-operate lines (UGCS, L1CE and MRT-7), and future lines (N1, N2SC, MMSP, L4, SLH). This is done through project design management, project monitoring and review, and through creating standards, policies in relation to GEDSI best practices for implementation in each component of the railway projects.	

From 2020 until present, I also oversee the GEDSI implementation in the NSCR-Ex Project in its Stations and Depots, and through streamlining and coordinating with Rolling Stock Systems, Operations and Maintenance, and Civil Works, making all these components accessible and inclusive.

C. Personnel's Career Development

As a practitioner of GEDSI mainstreaming in the level of project development, the scholarship is an opportunity for knowledge sharing and exchanges on topics which centers the capacity building of the transportation sector workforce on the best ways to address inclusive design infrastructure and service in the different assets of the Railways sector from the different existing, ongoing and future railway projects.

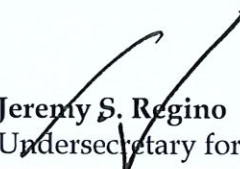
The scholarship will also provide opportunities to expand knowledge on effectively applying and embedding safeguards requirements to the future projects of the Railways sector through contributing to the improvements of the organizational structure involving a dedicated committee/TWG for the enforcement, monitoring and evaluation of an inclusive and accessible railways infrastructure and service regardless of concession contracts agreements, status and alike for an increased accountability and strict implementation to the project implementors. The learnings will also be helpful in the existing Railway projects that have already established their protocols but needs further improvement in their rigorous implementation and enforcement of an inclusive railways infrastructure and service.

III. SIGNIFICANT ACCOMPLISHMENTS/ CONTRIBUTIONS TO THE DEPARTMENT

1. **BP 344 Revised IRR;** Part of the TWG tasked to revise and write the IRR of the BP 344 – Accessibility Law which is due for signing of DOTr and DPWH Secretaries, with National Council on Disability Affairs, in the 1st Quarter of this year, 2024.
2. **Transit Facility Design Standards for Inclusive Facilities;** Part of the TWG tasked to write standards for Transit Facilities in relation to Inclusive Facilities as part of mainstreaming GEDSI in the Department. This is due to be published and signed as a Department Order for implementation to the Department.
3. **GEDSI and Accessibility Mainstreaming in the NSCR-Ex Project;** Lead in Stations and Depot GEDSI Infrastructure, and in support of mainstreaming GEDSI in O&M, Rolling Stock and Systems, Civil Works and GEDSI Team.
4. **Support and assistance for GEDSI and Accessibility Mainstreaming to other Railway Projects** (such as N1, MMSP, L4, SLH, UGCS, MRT-7, L1CE, AFCS, LRT-1, LRT-2 and MRT-3)

IV. GENDER EQUALITY, DISABILITY, AND SOCIAL INCLUSION(GEDSI)

1. Do you have mobility problems? Like difficulty in walking and/or climbing stairs?	• Yes	• No
2. Do you have an emotional/behavioral problem?	• Yes	• No
3. Do you have difficulty reading and identifying speech sounds?	• Yes	• No
4. Do you have difficulty reading and identifying speech sounds?	• Yes	• No

5. Do you have difficulty communicating?	☐ Yes	☒ No
6. Do you have difficulty remembering or concentrating?	☐ Yes	☒ No
7. Do you have difficulty doing simple arithmetic calculations?	☐ Yes	☒ No
8. Do you have difficulty reading even with corrective lenses?	☐ Yes	☒ No
9. Do you have any difficulty hearing?	☐ Yes	☒ No
10. Are you a solo parent?	☐ Yes	☒ No
11. Are you part of the Indigenous People group? (Please specify.) _____	☐ Yes	☒ No
<i>This is to certify that I have briefed the nominee on the expected output and we have agreed on how and when he/she will apply the new learning in the workplace.</i>		
Signature of Applicant:  Digitally signed by Awis Salima Bitana Date: 2024.04.17 21:13:02 +08'00' Salima B. Awis		Signature of Undersecretary Concerned/Head of the Agency/Secretary¹:  Jeremy S. Regino Undersecretary for Railways

¹ Applicants from DOTr CO shall need to secure the signature/approval of the Usec Concerned whereas Applicants from Attached Agencies and Sectoral Offices shall secure the signature/approval of their Head of Agency; Senior Officials including Head of Agency shall secure the signature/approval of the Secretary of Transportation (SOTr);



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Transportation

Document No: DOTr-HRDD-Forms-006A Rev. No.: 001 Effective Date: 03 April 2023

POTENTIAL AND PERSONALITY ASSESSMENT TRAIT FORM A (PPTAF A)
Technical/ Functional

INSTRUCTIONS: Rate the potential and personality traits of the candidate using the equivalent point scores. Take note that the result of this assessment shall be a part of the reference of the Personnel Development Committee in their rating.

TITLE OF THE SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM:	Australia Awards				
I. APPLICANT'S INFORMATION					
Name: Salima B. Awis	Position Title: Senior Transportation Development Officer				
Age: 28 years old	Division/Office: Office of the Undersecretary for Railways; Rail Unified Project Management Office – Project Development and Implementation Division				
CRITERIA	RATING GUIDE				
	5 (Excellent)	4 (Very Good)	3 (Good)	2 (Fair)	1 (Poor)
A. HUMAN RELATIONS					
a. The ability to adapt/adjust to the organization	•	•	•	•	•
b. The ability to relate with superiors	•	•	•	•	•
c. The ability to relate with peers in his/her unit	•	•	•	•	•
d. The ability to deal with the clientele or personnel outside his/her unit	•	•	•	•	•
B. LEADERSHIP					
a. The ability to encourage his/her peers and/or subordinates to participate in problem-solving and decision-making	•	•	•	•	•

C. WORK ORGANIZATION

- a. The ability to work in a well-organized and systematic manner

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D. REACTION TO PRESSURE

- a. The ability to work effectively even under pressure, conflict of priorities, and with the existing work environment

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- b. The ability to control negative emotions

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- c. The ability to accept criticisms objectively

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E. DEDICATION TO WORK

- a. The ability to cooperate for rush projects and/or special assignments

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F. RESOURCEFULNESS AND INITIATIVE

- a. The ability to accomplish assignments without close supervision

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- b. The ability to seek for additional assignments or offer his/her help to others after completing his/her work

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G. INTEREST IN THE ORGANIZATION

- a. The ability to support new systems or procedures that promote work efficiency

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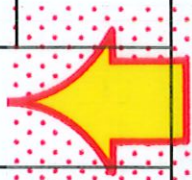
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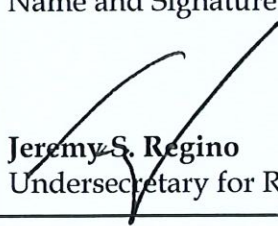
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This is to certify that the above information is true and correct.



Name and Signature of Office/Unit Head/ Immediate Supervisor:


Jeremy S. Regino
Undersecretary for Railways



Australia Awards

REAP Form (for Applicants of 2025 Intake)

The Re-entry Action Plan (REAP) is a formal document that represents a scholar's commitment to honor the conditions of the Australia Awards Scholarships (see Scholarship Handbook section 4.2). It is a mechanism that allows scholars to apply what they have learned in Australia to contribute to Philippine development through a meaningful project in an organisation or community.

- I. RELEVANCE OF THE REAP.** The REAP should clearly and succinctly explain how the delivery of its proposed output or outputs will improve the services or performance of the Host Organisation and ultimately contribute to the achievement of the goals set in the Philippine Government's Ambisyon Natin 2040, and the goals of the Australian Government in the Philippines.

Fill out the following sections after reading these required documents.

Name of Proponent	Salima B. Awis
REAP Title	<i>Inclusive Design Enforcement Plan for the Railways Sector</i>
REAP Objective	<i>This REAP aims to provide a systematic, time bound and effective enforcement plan of inclusive design for the Railways Sector's different projects, in different project timelines, through the realization of the two recently published technical standards for accessibility and inclusivity, Batas Pambansa (BP) 344 – Accessibility Law Revised Implementing Rules and Regulation, and Transit Facility Design Standards (TFDS): Inclusive Facilities</i>
Name of Host Organisation	<i>What is the name of the organisation where your REAP Project will be implemented (your own organisation or another organisation)?</i> <i>This REAP will be implemented to the Railways Sector of the Department of Transportation</i>
Description of the Host Organisation and relation to REAP	<i>How did you come to know about this organisation and why did you choose it to be your host?</i> <i>I am employed under the Department of Transportation – Railways Sector as Senior Transportation Development Officer. I oversee the Gender Equality, Disability and Social Inclusion (GEDSI)</i>

	Infrastructure workstream of the North-South Commuter Railway Extension (NSCR-Ex) Project Management Office. The NSCR-Ex Project, a flagship project of the Department and of the Railways Sector, was one of the few projects that were able to implement in advance different inclusive design best practices and policies as we were required by our loaning agency, Asian Development Bank. I chose our sector to be the host of my REAP as I've seen, as I assist the rest of the railway sector projects/ lines through my sectoral role, how the situation is different with the existing operating railway lines, soon-to-operate lines, ongoing construction railway lines and future railway lines as these projects have different project terms of references with different project requirements. There is definitely a need to streamline the process of implementing an inclusive railways service within the Railways Sector. Different railway projects experience difficulties in the implementation, especially in the past years when technical standards are non-existent, due to lack of budget, consultant and contractor apprehension, lack of staff capacity and technical know-how, lack of legal policies and requirements compelling the project to apply inclusive design, and not embedding inclusive design since the project inception. How can your relationship / connectedness with the Host Organisation help you in completely implementing your REAP? I was part of the TWGs of both technical standards, BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, who co-authored these documents, and my main workstream is GEDSI Infrastructure of the Railways Sector, therefore I am directly working and assisting in the implementation of Inclusive Infrastructure Design policies in all railway projects through my division, Project Development and Implementation Division, under Rail-Unified Project Management Office, side by side with my role of overseeing inclusive infrastructure in the NSCR-Ex Projects under the Infrastructure Design Section. Being in this position, I already have an overview of the current situation of the Railways Sector and how is the current situation of the implementation of inclusive design policies, as well as the gaps and difficulties that the Railways Sector face.
BACKGROUND INFORMATION	
Problem / Opportunity	• What problem or opportunity in the Host Organisation is your REAP hoping to address? • Cite specific examples, cases and/or reports to support your belief that this problem or opportunity really exists, is critical but not urgent. • You should articulate how this problem or opportunity is anchored on the situation of the Host Organisation. The REAP targeting the problem or opportunity of the Host Organisation is aligned to the goals set in the <u>Philippine Government's Ambisyon Natin 2040</u>, and the goals of the Australian Government in the Philippines set in the <u>Australian Government's Philippines COVID-19 Development Response Plan</u>. (500 words)

This REAP hopes to provide a systematic, time bound and effective implementation plan of inclusive design for the Railways Sector's different projects through the two recently published technical standards for accessibility and inclusivity, the BP 344 Revised IRR, and the TFDS: Inclusive Facilities.

The IRR of the BP 344 – Accessibility Law of the Philippines has recently been revised by our Department, DOTr where the revisions done aimed to incorporate the latest international practices in universal mobility into this vital legislation for the benefit of the persons with disabilities. More so, the TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, is a standard, published by DOTr through a department order, is a document that aims to standardize DOTr's transit facilities to become more convenient, accessible, safe, secure, and inclusive for all users, regardless of age, disability, physical stature, creed, sex, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression, parental status, marital status, ethnicity, socio-economic status, and other statuses. This document aims to support the Department's efforts in improving the mainstreaming of its Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI) initiatives across its various projects, and it also aims to address the intersectionality gaps from BP 344. Making these two standards fully effective in all the projects of DOTr through a robust implementation plan will help deliver inclusive outcomes for the Department.

BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities are not retroactive standards; therefore only future projects will be required to implement these new standards. It is anticipated, however, that existing operating Railway Lines will undergo renovations and retrofitting in the next years to come, which shall then be subject to the implementation of these standards. For example, the MRT-3 Railway Line of the Metro Manila, will be renovated 2 or more years from now.

As my previous experience in working and assisting different railway projects in promoting, embedding, and mainstreaming GEDSI in each of their project, I have witnessed how the different project management offices are lacking guidance in any inclusive design approach due to their limitation of having a dedicated team accountable for inclusivity mainstreaming, and also due to the unfamiliarity of the new standards that were published.

More so, from the articles and documentaries that have surfaced last 2023 regarding the inaccessibility of the three existing operating railway lines of DOTr, LRT-1, LRT-2 and MRT-3 have been subject to different criticisms and accessibility informal audits by private groups and persons with disabilities sector. Most of the issues that were raised has been addressed through operations, by providing inclusive service, and through providing ample and useful information to the passengers / persons with disabilities. However, all the three existing operating lines have difficulty in addressing the pointed accessibility and inclusivity issues if it already requires infrastructure renovations and retrofitting because of the lack of budget.

In the meantime, while these lines are acquiring budget for overall facilities improvements, a robust implementation plan for BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, and an overall inclusive design service shall be developed. This then targets the different

	implementation of the following Sustainable Development Goals which are: 1. SDG 8 Decent work and economic growth, SDG 4 Quality education – It shall reduce poverty and enhance work prospects for persons with disabilities, women, children, senior citizens, lgbtqia+ individuals as they may have more confidence in using public railway transportation therefore increasing their mobility, travel patterns, work opportunities and access to better education. 2. SDG 10 Reduced inequalities, SDG 5 Gender equality – as this REAP targets the implementation of an inclusive railways service through the enforcement of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, it directly aligns with the reduction of inequalities to the population, users and passengers regardless of their statuses (age, disability, physical stature, creed, sex, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression, parental status, marital status, ethnicity, socio-economic status, and other statuses.) 3. SDG 11 Sustainable cities and communities, Industry Innovation and Infrastructure – this REAP targets to improve physical and information access through implementation of infrastructure standards that improves the accessibility and inclusivity of the Railway trains and stations. Lastly, while the concerned agencies, Department of Transportation, Department of Public Works and Highways and the National Council on Disability Affairs, that were involved in the drafting of the technical standards, are ongoing in the information dissemination and general capacity building for all the stakeholders of the BP 344 Revised IRR and the TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, what shall come next would be the standards' actual implementation and enforcement to the projects that will come after the publishing, which will just be in time right when this proposed REAP is finished. Effectivity of the enforcement of both BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities will rely on the robustness of its Implementation Plan which shall cover its effective and systematic enforcement, as well as its monitoring and evaluation.
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BENEFICIARIES

Direct Beneficiary	<i>Who will directly benefit from the implementation of your REAP? How many target beneficiaries does your REAP have? How will your REAP help your target beneficiaries? (200 words)</i> <i>The Railways Sector will directly benefit on the implementation of this REAP as this aims to provide guidance to the implementors of the different railway projects of the department.</i> <i>In doing so, this will then benefit all the passengers using the railways service of the department, specifically the persons with disabilities, pregnant, senior citizens, children and the rest of the groups that are part of the vulnerable population.</i> <i>It shall also be acknowledged that providing an inclusive railways service will also benefit the department, the railways sector and its Operators as it has been proven that an inclusive railways service produces higher profit income to the service providers as it welcomes</i>
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	more passenger to use the facilities including persons with disabilities, women, children, senior citizens and LGBTQIA+ individuals who also have disposable incomes which will contribute to the profit of the Railways Operators/ Sectors.
Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI)	How will women and other marginalised groups (i.e., IP, PWD, LGBTQ++, etc) benefit from the implementation of your REAP? Provide specific strategies to respond to the needs of the specific groups. (200 words) <i>This REAP is directly addressing the implementation and enforcement of the GEDSI policies in the department, hence directly targets how to make up and apply the inclusive railways service. In providing guidance to the implementation of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, the Railways Sector will have a step by step and applicable way to effectively implement these policies which will benefit the passengers through:</i> <i>1. For persons with disabilities, Senior citizens – full enforcement of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS Inclusive Facilities on different projects of the Railways sector will help improve on the accessibility of the stations, trains and the railways service. Providing a fully accessible and inclusive facilities will encourage persons with disabilities to use the railways service which will improve their mobility, hence expanding the different opportunities and options they may be provided with, improving their quality of life.</i> <i>2. For Women, Children – in the implementation of an inclusive railways service through the BP 344 and Inclusive Facilities enforcement, this will help improve in the transportation patterns for women making it convenient for them to choose the public transportation by providing inclusive facilities. It is known that women/ mothers have different transportation patterns because of their acquired domestic roles in a household on top of their daily work. In providing an inclusive railways service, women will have more confidence when accessing the railway facilities hence improving their transportation patterns. In the long run, the REAP also aims to improve the options of women in transportation modes by using an inclusive railways service so they won't have to be limited in the location of the work available for them, at the same time fulfilling their chosen household duties.</i> <i>3. For LGBTQIA+ individuals – full enforcement of accessible and inclusive facilities in the Railways sector will provide a safe and inclusive space for passengers with diverse SOGIESC that will choose to use the railway network. LGBTQIA+ individuals will have confidence that they will not be discriminated in the railway facilities by knowing that inclusive facilities are readily provided for all.</i>

Climate Change Adaptation, Disaster Risk Reduction and Environmental Protection	<i>How your REAP will contribute to climate change adaptation, disaster risk reduction and environmental protection? The contribution could be in the manner of REAP implementation (e.g., use of products/materials that are environment-friendly or reducing the carbon footprints) or the use of REAP output/s to mitigate climate and disaster risks and protect the environment. (200 words)</i> <i>Improving the Railways by the implementation of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive facilities will give confidence to commuters and passengers in using railway facilities. Therefore, lessening each commuters and passengers carbon footprint as they subscribe with mass transportation vs owning and using personal vehicle which just benefit a few people per vehicle per trip.</i>
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II. **IMPACT AND SUSTAINABILITY OF THE ORGANISATIONAL OUTCOME OF THE REAP.**

The REAP should produce an output/s that will help the Host Organisation improve their services or performance. These improvements are the outcome/s of your REAP. You should therefore clearly articulate your strategies for the Host Organisation will sustain the gains of the REAP after its completion. (TIP: Based on our survey, the following factors ensure the effective implementation of REAP: the goals of the REAP should align with the goals of the Host Organisation and the Host Organisation is committed to the completion and full implementation of your REAP.)

Development impact and Sustainability	<i>How will your REAP contribute to the achievement of the goals of the Host Organisation?</i> <i>What is your strategy to ensure that the gains of the REAP will be institutionalised and sustained beyond the REAP completion?</i> <i>(400 words)</i> <i>The Department is dedicated in providing Comfortable, Accessible, Safe, Sustainable, and Affordable (CASSA) transportation for every Filipino. To fulfill the Department's commitment to Comfortable and Accessible transportation, it is necessary that inclusive railway facilities and operations be established consistently throughout the railway network. As this REAP focuses on the Comfortability and Accessibility, which directly translates to an inclusive railways service, it is aligned with the goals of the Department, particularly by our current head of the Department.</i> <i>As this REAP will only focus on the implementation to the Railways sector, the outcome initiatives may be used in the further mainstreaming of GEDSI in other sector such as Road, Maritime and Aviation sectors. A dedicated committee / TWG may be created department wide which shall monitor all the relative inclusivity implementation of the transportation of the department, and of the Philippines. The process of providing an overall inclusive service will be centralized, with top to bottom approach, influencing the procedures of the enforcement and implementation of inclusivity in the different department's railway, maritime, road and aviation sectors.</i> <i>The REAP can be escalated as a Department Order within the</i>
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	Department of Transportation which will mobilize creating a committee/ TWG or even an office which specializes and focuses on anything related to the implementation of an inclusive transportation service through infrastructure, operations and information mitigations and enforcement. In this manner, support shall be sought from the Planning and Project Development arm of the Department as this is also the sector that initiates the creation of the two new (and existing) inclusive infrastructure standards which are the BP 344 Accessibility Law Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities.
Organisational Outcome	Identify at least one outcome of your REAP. How will your REAP improve service delivery, policies, systems, or competencies in the Host Organisation? Please identify which organizational outcome your REAP will address: ○ Improvement of Services Delivery ○ Improvement on Organisational Structure ○ Systems Improvement ○ Policy Review and Formulation ○ Building Competencies ○ Others (200 words) The organization will improve the services delivery, organizational structure, systems, and policy review and formulation through the creation of a dedicated committee or TWG which will focus on the accessibility and inclusivity improvement of all the Railways Project moving forward. As per the different international practices, at a Department/ Ministry for Transport, I noticed that there is always a dedicated committee/ TWG that are involved of ensuring that all the facilities and operational procedures of the transportation facilities are accessible and inclusive. If the inclusive design enforcement plan will be realized, one of its key outcomes is to have a dedicated committee/ TWG, therefore improving the process of the Railways Sector/ department in having an inclusive railways service.
Output	What output/s will your REAP produce? How will these outputs contribute to achieving the targeted organisational outcome? (200 words) This REAP aims to have an output that will provide a systematic, time bound and effective enforcement plan of inclusive design for the Railways Sector's different projects, in different project timelines, through the realization of BP 344 Revised IRR and Inclusive Facilities. As mentioned above, the creation of a dedicated committee/ TWG which will focus solely on the enforcement, monitoring and evaluation of an inclusive railways service will start and create a streamlined process for the Railways Sector. Through the committee/ TWG, it will help push and prioritize providing inclusive infrastructure and railways service such as provisions for all-inclusive toilets, breastfeeding rooms, accessible and inclusive passenger route, accessible conveyances – all this will be provided for both passengers and station personnel.

Competencies	<i>What competencies do you hope to improve or gain when you study in Australia? How will your proposed program of study help provide these competencies? You must clearly and succinctly articulate the importance of your proposed program of study to providing the competencies you need to implement your REAP. (200 words)</i> <i>I have recently known, through a recent workshop with the Partners for Infrastructure of the Australian Embassy, that the Queensland government have an accessibility committee/ office that are dedicated in the enforcement, monitoring and evaluation, and even improvements of existing policies regarding an inclusive and accessible overall transportation for Queensland. I'd like to know more in depth, how the Australian Government from the federal to the state level, until at the concentrated government, how they were able to push for accessible and inclusive transport with the top to bottom approach, and how necessary and influential it is in their context.</i> <i>With the difference of governance with Australia, I acknowledge that some of the difficulties of the Philippine government may not be seen and applicable, but any strategies and approach will still be helpful as long as it aligns with the goal of an inclusive railways service.</i> <i>Knowing this, I'd like to focus on policy making/ developmental management courses that are also in connection to an inclusive built-environment programs available in Australian universities.</i>
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III. IMPLEMENTABILITY OF THE REAP. The REAP should be fully implemented within two years from when a scholar returns from Australia. The applicant should clearly and succinctly explain how he/she will implement the REAP within the required timeframe and budget. (TIP: The scale of your REAP should be within your circle of influence and control to ensure doability.)

Measurability

How will you track the progress of the implementation of your REAP? What are your milestones? Divide your REAP activities and timeline into four (4) milestones: 25%, 50%, 75% and 100%.

Action Steps (What activities will contribute to the milestones)	Expected Output	Timeline
25%		
Production of an enforcement, monitoring, and evaluation plan of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities for different stages of the different Railways Project.	Final Implementation Plan of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities	6 months
50%		
Creation of a committee that will focus on the implementation of an Inclusive Railway Facilities. Their mandate will solely focus on the	Inclusive Design Committee involving key representatives that are directly involved in the different railway projects	2 months

enforcement, monitoring and evaluation of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities.	implementation	
75%		
Seek the approval of the principals on the final implementation plan of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities with the Inclusive Design Committee	Signed and approved final Enforcement Plan of BP 344 Revised IRR and TFDS; Inclusive Facilities, and Inclusive Design Committee	2 months
100%		
Issuance and application of the Inclusive Design Enforcement Plan for the Railways Sector to the different Railways project with different project timelines and statuses. Mobilization of the Inclusive Design Committee.	Memo of instruction for the application of the Inclusive Design Enforcement Plan Start of enforcement of inclusive design to the different railways projects.	1 month (issuance)

Resources	<i>Estimate the budget (in terms of pesos per budget item) you require to successfully implement your REAP. Include your strategy for accessing the necessary financial support.</i> <i>Note that Australia Awards will not fund your REAP implementation. (200 words)</i> <i>As this REAP will require an existing office, which is the Railways Sector, to implement a proposed enforcement plan, this REAP shall use the resources and the workforce of the railways office. Hence, it is unmeasurable as of now as it will maximize the workforce present through a creating a committee or a Technical Working Group.</i> <i>Another option would be, is for the Railways Sector to hire a committee or a group solely dedicated in the implementation of the enforcement plan as well as its monitoring and evaluation of the different railways project up until its Operations and Maintenance. Therefore, this will entail an additional workforce to the organizational structure of the Railways sector which will add to the expenses of the department providing compensation to the committee.</i>
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REAP Start Date and End Date	As early as December of 2025
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RISKS AND MITIGATING MEASURE

Describe the risks that might impact on the success of the Action Plan and how you plan to manage these to ensure success. (Identify factors that will block/limit/slowdown accomplishment of intended results or lessen quality of outputs.)

RISK	MITIGATING MEASURE
<i>Change of administration and instruction</i>	<i>A sustainable and approved plan must be established before the change of administration happens. In this way, continuation of the implementation plan will be assured regardless of the administration.</i>
<i>Budget allocation</i>	<i>Budget allocation for the Department which will be used for the implementation to the projects may take a long time before being granted. Airtight justification on the urgency and need for such enforcement plan shall be provided so the budget allocation to provide an inclusive railway service will be secured.</i>

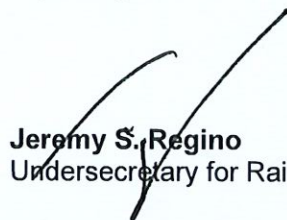
Signed by:



Salima B. Awis

Digitally signed by
Awis Salima Bitana
Date: 2024.04.17
21:30:29 +08'00'

Signed by:



Jeremy S. Regino
Undersecretary for Railways

